What is a SaaS go-to-market strategy and how to build one in 2026

SaaS Go-To-Market Strategy Script (Rewritten + Extended)

SECTION 1 — HOOK (0:00–0:45)

Most SaaS teams treat go-to-market like a one-time event.
Launch the product. Run some campaigns. Then move on.

That's not a strategy.
That's a guess.
And guessing is one of the fastest ways to **burn cash in SaaS.**

Your go-to-market strategy is the operating system that decides
- who you sell to,
-why they buy,
- how they find you,
- how you price,
- and how you measure growth.

If that system is off, strong execution won't save you. You'll attract the wrong buyers with the wrong message in the wrong channels and wonder why growth feels heavier than it should.

In this video, I'll show you what GTM actually is, why most teams misunderstand it, and a six-step system to turn GTM from a launch plan into a repeatable growth engine.

And the first place GTM breaks is earlier than most teams expect.

SECTION 2 — What GTM Actually Is (0:45–2:15)

A GTM strategy is your plan for bringing a product to market and turning it into revenue — over and over, not just once.

This is where most teams drift.

They jump straight to tactics.
Ads. Outbound. Content. Partnerships.

And tactics break when a few basic questions aren't answered first.

First — who are you selling to, specifically?
Not "mid-market."
The actual companies and roles that feel this problem today.

Next — why will they buy?
Why your product beats doing nothing… or picking another option.

Then — what should you charge?
Pricing that reflects real value without slowing adoption.

Next — how will they find you?
The channels buyers actually use when they're evaluating tools like yours.

And finally — how do you know it's working?
The metrics that tell you whether growth is healthy… or quietly breaking.

If you can't answer those clearly, you're not really running GTM.
You're running a bunch of disconnected experiments.

Your GTM strategy exists to answer those questions — and keep updating the answers as the market changes.

And once you do that, the next mistake shows up fast.

Teams start treating GTM like it's just marketing.

SECTION 3 — Why GTM Is Not Marketing (2:15–3:15)

Marketing answers one part of the puzzle:
How do we generate demand?

GTM answers the full system that connects sales, marketing, product, and customer success.

Marketing is just one input.

When teams mix these up, predictable things happen.

Marketing runs campaigns that sales can't convert.
Sales chases accounts product wasn't built for.
Product ships features that don't solve real buying problems.

This isn't a people problem.
It's a system design problem.

And most systems fail at alignment.

SECTION 4 — The Alignment Problem (3:15–4:45)

Most GTM strategies don't fail because the tactics are bad.

They fail because teams aren't aligned on what "good" even means.

Sales and marketing disagree on what a qualified lead actually looks like. Marketing sends over leads that sales won't touch because they don't fit the profile reps know how to close.

Product builds features for buyer personas no one's actively targeting — or that sales doesn't know how to position. So those features sit unused, and the roadmap drifts further from what actually drives revenue.

Alignment isn't a vibe. It requires four specific things.

1) A shared ICP. That's your ideal customer profile — the type of company that's most likely to buy, stay, and expand. If marketing is targeting Series A startups and sales only closes with Series C companies, you're burning budget on leads that were never going to convert.

2) Agreed lead definitions. Everyone knows what qualifies a lead to move forward — and what doesn't. This means sales stops complaining about "bad leads," and marketing stops getting blamed for low conversion when the real issue is misalignment on fit.

3) Clear handoffs. Sales can see what content a buyer engaged with, what problem they showed interest in, and where they are in the buying process. Without this visibility, reps walk into calls blind — and buyers have to repeat themselves.

4) Unified metrics. One shared view of pipeline, conversion rates, and revenue — not four dashboards telling four different stories. When everyone's looking at the same numbers, you can actually diagnose what's broken instead of arguing about whose data is right.

Without alignment, GTM lives in slide decks and strategy docs that no one follows.

With alignment, GTM becomes an operating system that runs your entire revenue motion.

Now let’s talk about how to actually build that system.

SECTION 5 — The Six-Step GTM System (4:45–7:30)

Now here's what a **real GTM system looks like** — six steps that turn those questions into a repeatable process.

Step one: Validate product-market fit.
That means customers stick around, use more than one feature, and don’t need constant discounts to stay.
If churn is high or deals only close with heavy discounts, GTM isn’t the issue yet.

Step two: Build your ICP and prioritize segments.
Use company size, industry, and tech stack to define your best buyers.
Then narrow.
Trying to serve everyone slows learning and burns budget.

Step three: Develop messaging and positioning.
Features explain what your product does.
Outcomes explain why buyers care.
Lead with the problem you remove, not the tool you built.

Step four: Choose your GTM motion.
Product-led works when the product is simple and deal size is low.
Sales-led works when buying is complex and deals are larger.
Most SaaS teams end up hybrid.

This just means deciding whether growth starts with the product, with sales conversations, or a mix of both.

Step five: Align teams around revenue.
Shared ICP.
Shared definitions.
Shared pipeline view.

Step six: Build the tech stack to support the system.
CRM, engagement tools, data, automation.
Tools support process.
They don't create it.

Now here's the SaaS-specific trap most teams fall into.

SECTION 6 (SOCIAL) — The SaaS Trap: Scaling GTM Before the Product Is Ready (7:30–8:30)

SaaS teams scale GTM too early.
They add reps, tools, and spend before the product is ready to carry growth.

That looks like:

High churn after onboarding
Deals that close but don't expand
Customers who use one feature and then disappear

This is how SaaS burns cash quietly.

The rule is simple.
If retention is weak, fix product experience before scaling GTM.
If expansion is weak, fix value delivery before scaling GTM.

Otherwise you're just pouring more traffic into a leaky system.

And that brings us to how you know your GTM is working.

SECTION 7 — The Metrics That Actually Matter (8:30–9:30)

Now, if GTM is a system, you need to know when that system is breaking.
These five metrics tell you where things are actually going wrong.

First — CAC. Customer Acquisition Cost.
This is how much you spend in sales and marketing to land one new customer.

If it costs you ten thousand dollars to close a deal, that's your CAC.

When CAC starts rising, growth is getting more expensive.
That usually means something upstream is off — your targeting, your message, or how deals are moving through sales.

Next — LTV. Lifetime Value.
This is how much revenue a customer brings in over the full time they stay with you.

If someone pays two thousand a year and stays for three years, that's six thousand in lifetime value.

Here's the simple rule: LTV should be much higher than CAC.
If it isn't, you're working harder to acquire customers than the value you get back.

Then there's churn.
Churn is how many customers you lose over a period of time.

If you start the year with one hundred customers and twenty cancel, that's twenty percent churn.

High churn means customers aren't getting value.
And no amount of new sales can fix a product or experience people don't want to stick with.

Next is Net Revenue Retention — or NRR.
This tells you whether your existing customers are growing with you.

If you start the year with a million dollars from existing customers,
and those same accounts end the year paying you one-point-two million,
your NRR is one-twenty percent.

Anything over one hundred percent means growth is compounding inside your customer base.
Below one hundred percent means you're shrinking underneath the surface — even if new sales look healthy.

And finally — win rate.
This is the percentage of qualified deals that actually close.

If your team runs one hundred demos and closes twenty-five deals, that's a twenty-five percent win rate.

When win rate drops, it usually means your sales motion doesn't match how buyers want to buy —
or you're talking to the wrong accounts in the first place.

Here's the pattern to watch for.

Rising CAC usually points to targeting or messaging problems.
Falling win rate points to a sales motion problem.
High churn points to a product or customer experience problem.
NRR under one hundred percent means you're replacing lost revenue instead of compounding growth.

These metrics don't tell you if your team is busy.
They tell you if your GTM system is healthy.

SECTION 8 — Bottom Line + Next Steps (9:30–10:15)

Here's the bottom line.

Your go-to-market strategy isn't a launch plan.
It's the operating system that decides whether SaaS growth compounds or stalls.

Before tactics, get clear on five things:
-Who you sell to
- Why they buy
-What you charge
- How they find you
-How you measure success

Then build the system:
- Validate fit
-Define ICP
- Develop messaging
- Choose your motion
- Align teams
- Support it with the right tools

If you want a practical starting point, here's your next step today:

Write down your ICP in one sentence.
Then list the last five deals you closed.
If three of them don't match that ICP, your GTM system is drifting.

Drop your ICP sentence in the comments.
If it's too broad, I'll call it out.
If it's too narrow, I'll help you adjust it so it actually matches how you sell.

That one sentence alone will tell you more about your GTM health than most dashboards ever will.